

Word family: **retire / retired / retiring / retirement / retiree**

Base word: retire

Past tense: retired

Past participle: retired

Related forms: retired, retiring, retirement, retiree

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞) / noun-related forms (相關名詞)

Your sentence:

> “One person I find genuinely interesting is my former neighbour, Mr. Wong, who is a **retired radio journalist** in his late sixties.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **retired** means that Mr. Wong **used to work professionally as a radio journalist but has permanently stopped working in that career**.

This commonly happens because of age, although *retire* does not itself mean that someone must be elderly.

繁體中文： ** **以前從事某項職業，但現已正式停止工作或結束該職業生涯**

中文翻譯：

> “...Mr. Wong, who is a **retired radio journalist** in his late sixties.”

「.....黃先生是一位六十多歲、**已退休的電台記者**。」

Here:

retired radio journalist = 以前以電台記者為職業，但現在已結束該職業生涯的人

1. **retire / retired + career/job/profession (職業 / 工作生涯) — 退休；結束職業生涯**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To permanently stop working, or permanently stop working in a particular profession or career, especially after many years of work.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Mr. Wong is a **retired radio journalist** in his late sixties.”

「黃先生是一位六十多歲、**已退休的電台記者**。」

Practice 2

> “She plans to **retire** from teaching next year.”

「她計劃明年**退休，結束教學生涯**。」

Practice 3

> “My father **retired** at the age of sixty-five.”

「我父親六十五歲時**退休了**。」

****retire = 正式停止工作或結束長期從事的職業生涯****

This includes:

- * retire from teaching
- * retire from banking
- * retire as a journalist
- * retired doctor
- * retired teacher
- * retired athlete

These do ****not**** need separate meanings merely because the profession changes. Under the Golden Manual, the underlying semantic concept is the same.

2. ****retire from + sport/activity (運動 / 長期活動) — 正式退出；結束參與生涯****

This is very closely related to career retirement, but worth showing as a contextual branch rather than inventing a wholly separate core meaning.

A person can ****retire from professional sport, competition, politics, performance, or another long-term activity**** even when ordinary paid employment is not the main idea.

Practice 4

> “The tennis player ****retired from professional competition**** at thirty-four.”

「那名網球員三十四歲時****正式退出職業賽事，結束競賽生涯****。」

Practice 5

> “After twenty years on stage, she decided to **retire from performing**.”

「在舞台上表演了二十年後，她決定**退出表演工作，結束演藝生涯**。」

retire from an activity = 正式而長期地停止參與原本持續從事的專業或主要活動

I would **not count this as an entirely separate database meaning from #1** if your database is counting core semantic senses. Both share:

> **permanently ending one's active participation in a career or long-term role**

3. **retire from + match/race/game (比賽) — 中途退出；未完成比賽便退賽**

This one should be kept separate.

Here, the person is **not necessarily ending their career**. They are withdrawing from **one particular event**, often because of injury, illness, or mechanical problems.

Practice 6

> “She was forced to **retire from the match** because of a knee injury.”

「她因膝傷被迫**中途退出那場比賽 / 退賽**。」

Practice 7

> “The driver **retired from the race** after his engine failed.”

「那名車手因引擎故障而**中途退出比賽**。」

retire from a match/race = 在比賽完成之前停止參賽並退出該場賽事

Compare:

> “He **retired from tennis**.”

= 他結束了網球職業生涯。

> “He **retired from the match**.”

= 他只是在那場比賽中途退賽。

This distinction is important for learners.

4. **retire to bed / retire for the night — 就寢；上床睡覺**

This is a well-established but somewhat formal use.

Meaning: To go to bed, especially at the end of the evening.

Practice 8

> “After dinner, he **retired to bed** early.”

「晚飯後，他很早便**上床休息 / 就寢**。」

Practice 9

> “I think I’ll **retire for the night**.”

「我想我要**去睡覺 / 就寢了**。」

retire to bed / for the night = 結束當晚的活動並去睡覺；較正式的說法

In everyday conversation, people are more likely to say:

> “go to bed”

rather than:

> “retire to bed”

So the sense is current, but the register should be marked as **formal / somewhat old-fashioned in casual speech**.

5. **retire to + private/quiet place (較安靜 / 私人地方) — 退到；離開眾人到另一地方**

This develops from the older core idea of **withdrawing**.

Meaning: To leave a group or public area and go somewhere quieter, more private, or separate.

Practice 10

> “After dinner, they **retired to the living room** for coffee.”

「晚飯後，他們**移步到客廳**喝咖啡。」

Practice 11

> “He **retired to his study** to finish some work.”

「他**回到 / 退到自己的書房**完成一些工作。」

retire to + place = 離開目前的人群或活動場所，轉到較私人、安靜或另外一個地方

Again, this is more formal than everyday:

> go to

> move to

> head to

6. **retire + equipment/product/vehicle/system (設備 / 產品 / 交通工具 / 系統) — 正式停用 ; 淘汰**

Here, **retire** is transitive.

****Meaning:**** To permanently remove something from active use or service because it is old, obsolete, unnecessary, or being replaced.

Practice 12

> “The airline plans to **retire** its oldest aircraft.”

「航空公司計劃把最舊的一批飛機**正式退役 / 停止使用**。」

Practice 13

> “The company **retired** the old computer system after twenty years.”

「公司在使用二十年後，把舊電腦系統**正式停用 / 淘汰**。」

****retire something = 正式把設備、機器、交通工具、產品或系統永久停止使用****

Common contexts:

* retire an aircraft

* retire a train

* retire a ship

* retire old equipment

* retire a software system

* retire a product

The Chinese translation changes naturally:

* aircraft → **退役**

* software → **停用**

* product → **停售 / 淘汰**

But these remain **one underlying English sense**: removing something permanently from active use.

7. **retire + number/jersey (球衣號碼) — 永久停止使用某號碼以表彰某人**

This belongs to the broader **remove from use** sense in #6 rather than requiring a completely separate core meaning.

Practice 14

> “The team **retired his number** after he ended his career.”

「球隊在他結束職業生涯後，**永久停用了他的球衣號碼，以表彰他的貢獻**。」

Practice 15

> “Her jersey number was officially **retired**.”

「她的球衣號碼被正式**封存，不再由其他球員使用**。」

retire a number = 正式永久停止使用某位著名球員的號碼，通常是為了表彰其成就

Useful contextual subtype, but semantically it still means:

> **remove something permanently from active use**

8. **retire + debt/bond/shares (債務 / 債券 / 股份) — 償清 ; 贖回 ; 註銷**

This is an established financial/business meaning.

Meaning: To pay off, redeem, cancel, or otherwise remove a financial obligation or security from circulation.

Practice 16

> “The company used the proceeds to **retire some of its debt**.”

「公司利用所得款項**償還 / 清償部分債務**。」

Practice 17

> “The bonds will be **retired** when they mature.”

「這批債券到期後將被**贖回並註銷**。」

****retire debt/securities = 透過償還、贖回或註銷，使債務或金融證券不再存在或流通****

This is specialized compared with everyday *retire*, but it is sufficiently established in business and finance to be useful under the SOP's modern domain-specific rule.

9. ****retire + batter/side (棒球) — 使出局****

This is a distinct baseball meaning, especially common in American sports English.

Practice 18

> “The pitcher **retired the first three batters**.”

「投手令最先上場的三名打者全部**出局**。」

Practice 19

> “He struck out the final batter to **retire the side**.”

「他三振最後一名打者，令該半局的進攻方全部**出局**。」

****retire a batter/the side = 在棒球比賽中令打者或進攻方出局****

This is genuinely different from ordinary workplace retirement and therefore qualifies as a separate domain-specific sense.

Related form: ****retirement****

****Retirement**** has the corresponding core meanings connected with stopping work or withdrawing something from use.

retirement = 退休；退休生活 / 退休狀態

> “She is enjoying her **retirement**.”

「她正在享受自己的**退休生活**。」

retirement = 正式結束職業或競賽生涯

> “He announced his **retirement from professional football**.”

「他宣布**退出職業足球，結束球員生涯**。」

retirement of equipment/debt

> “The **retirement of the old aircraft** will begin next year.”

「這批舊飛機的**退役 / 停用**工作將於明年開始。」

The noun normally inherits the relevant sense of **retire** rather than creating unrelated polysemy.

Related form: **retiree**

Retiree means:

a person who has retired from employment

Practice 20

> “The town is popular with **retirees**.”

「這個小鎮很受**退休人士**歡迎。」

Practice 21

> “Many **retirees** choose to travel more.”

「很多**退休人士**會選擇增加旅行的時間。」

retiree = 已正式停止工作並進入退休生活的人

This is especially common in American English.

Important special case: **retiring**

There are actually **two** important uses of **retiring**.

retiring = about to leave a position / ending a career

> “The **retiring** director thanked the staff.”

「那位**即將卸任 / 退休的董事**感謝員工。」

Here it clearly belongs to the **retire** family.

But there is another established adjective:

retiring = shy, quiet, and unwilling to attract attention — **害羞內斂的**

Practice 22

> “She has a rather **retiring** personality.”

「她的性格頗為**害羞內斂**，不喜歡引人注意。」

Practice 23

> “Despite his talent, he remained quiet and **retiring**.”

「儘管很有才華，他仍然十分**低調內向、不愛出風頭**。」

retiring = 性格害羞、低調，不喜歡受到別人注意

This meaning is genuinely different from:

> **retiring** employee = **即將退休的僱員**

So it deserves an explicit contrast.

Important distinction: **retired** vs **retiring**

retired

The career has already ended.

> “a **retired** journalist”

= 已經退休的記者

retiring

The person is **in the process of leaving / about to leave** the role.

> “the **retiring CEO**”

= 即將卸任的行政總裁

But remember:

> “a **retiring personality**”

does **not** mean someone is about to retire.

It means:

害羞內斂、不愛引人注意的性格

Important distinction: **retire vs resign**

These are not the same.

retire

Usually means permanently ending one's working career or long-term professional activity.

> “She **retired** at sixty-five.”

「她六十五歲退休。」

resign

Means voluntarily leaving a particular job or official position.

> “She **resigned** as manager.”

「她辭去了經理職位。」

After resigning, she may immediately take another job.

After retiring, the usual implication is that she is **ending or substantially withdrawing from her

working career**.

Important distinction: **retire vs quit**

quit

Very broad and often informal:

- > quit a job
- > quit smoking
- > quit the team

= 停止 / 辭去 / 退出

retire

Usually carries a more specific idea of:

- * formally ending a career;
- * withdrawing from an event;
- * or officially taking something out of service.

Therefore:

- > “He quit his job.”

does not necessarily mean he retired.

He might start another job tomorrow.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is:

- * **retire**
- * **retired**
- * **retiring**
- * **retirement**
- * **retiree**

A particularly useful point is that **retiring** develops an established adjective meaning **shy and unobtrusive**, which should not be mistaken for “about to retire.”

The Golden Manual requires this kind of word-family audit while also removing obscure or unhelpful derivatives.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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retire — career/work	正式而永久停止工作或結束長期從事的職業生涯
retire from sport/activity	正式結束長期參與的專業、競賽或主要活動；屬於職業 / 活動退休的同一核心概念
retire from a match/race	在某一場比賽完成之前中途退出，而不一定結束整個職業生涯
retire to bed / for the night	結束當晚活動並去睡覺；較正式
retire to + place	離開目前的人群或活動場所，轉到較安靜、私人或另一個地方
retire equipment/system/vehicle	把設備、交通工具、產品或系統永久停止使用或正式退役
retire a number	為表彰球員而永久停止使用其球衣號碼；屬於「永久停止使用」的延伸
retire debt/bonds/shares	透過償還、贖回或註銷，使債務或證券不再存在或流通
retire a batter/the side	在棒球中令打者或進攻方出局
retirement	退休、退休狀態，或正式結束職業 / 競賽生涯
retiree	已停止工作並進入退休生活的人
retiring — leaving role	即將退休、卸任或離開原有職位的
retiring — personality	性格害羞、低調，不喜歡受到別人注意的

For your original sentence

> “Mr. Wong, who is a ****retired radio journalist**** in his late sixties.”

The exact meaning is:

****retired = 已經正式結束原本的職業生涯，不再從事該職業的****

More specifically:

****retired radio journalist = 以前以電台記者為職業，但現在已經退休、不再從事該職業的人****

So for your database, I would count ****7 genuinely separate core polysemy meanings**** for ****retire**** itself:

1. ****end a career / long-term professional activity****

2. **withdraw from one particular match/race**
3. **go to bed**
4. **withdraw to another/private place**
5. **take something permanently out of service**
6. **pay off/redeem/cancel debt or securities**
7. **baseball: get a batter/side out**

I would **not** count *retire from sport* separately from career retirement, nor *retire a jersey number* separately from taking something out of use.